

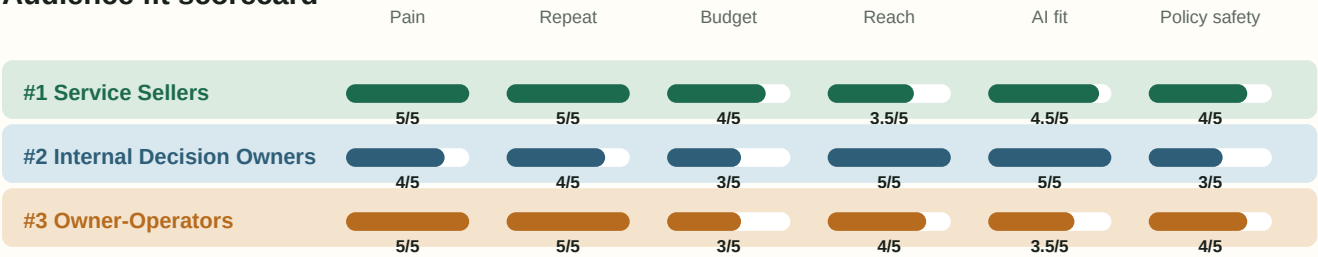
toward.to Audience Pitch

The first paid-acquisition audiences should be people who have to make a call they may later have to defend.

Sell the moment before commitment: 'What am I missing before I say yes?'

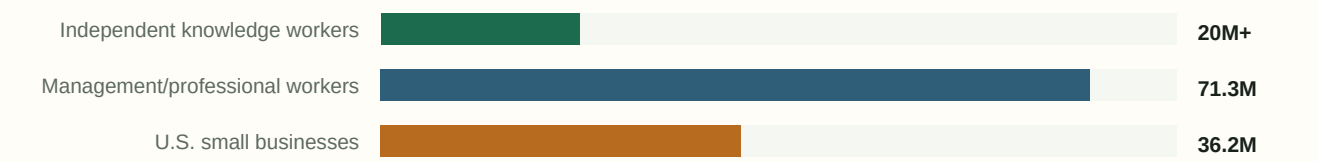
Decision: keep the three-audience system, but make each audience narrower. The winning wedge is not generic productivity, generic founders, or broad fear. It is pressure-tested judgment: a recommendation, a business call, or a next best action that carries consequences.

Audience fit scorecard



Scores are synthesis ratings from source-backed evidence: 5 is strongest.

Current market scale signals



Sources: Upwork Future Workforce Index [S2], BLS CPS annual averages [S3], SBA FAQ [S7].

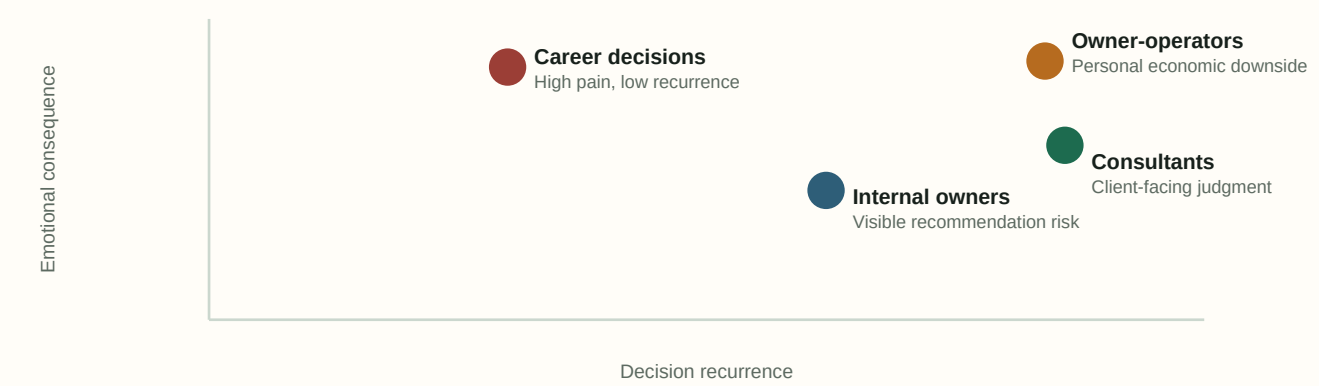
The Recommendation

The best audience is not the bravest person, the most anxious person, or the broadest person. It is the person whose status, revenue, or margin depends on making a better call under imperfect information.

toward.to's public product language already points in this direction: advisor perspectives, constraints, blind spots, and a next best action. That creates a clean paid message: bring one messy decision, get a defensible next move. [S1]

Rank	Audience	Plain-English buyer	Emotional anchor	Example decision
#1	Consultants / Service Sellers	Solo consultants, agency owners, fractional operators, recruiters, coaches, accountants, and advisors whose product is judgment.	I cannot hand a client a fuzzy recommendation.	A client wants a scope change, pricing call, hiring recommendation, or go/no-go decision. The seller needs a sharper point of view before the next call.
#2	White-Collar Decision Owners	PMs, ops leads, marketers, analysts, recruiters, chiefs of staff, and managers who must bring recommendations upward.	I need to walk into the meeting with an answer I can defend.	They have to recommend launch, delay, cut scope, hire, change priority, or pick a segment while knowing the second question may expose weak thinking.
#3	Small-Business Decision Owners	Digitally active owners and operators in 2-50 person firms who make pricing, hiring, client, software, and growth calls.	If this call is wrong, I am the one who pays for it.	They need to decide whether to hire, raise prices, fire a client, invest in a channel, buy software, or launch an offer.

The positioning map

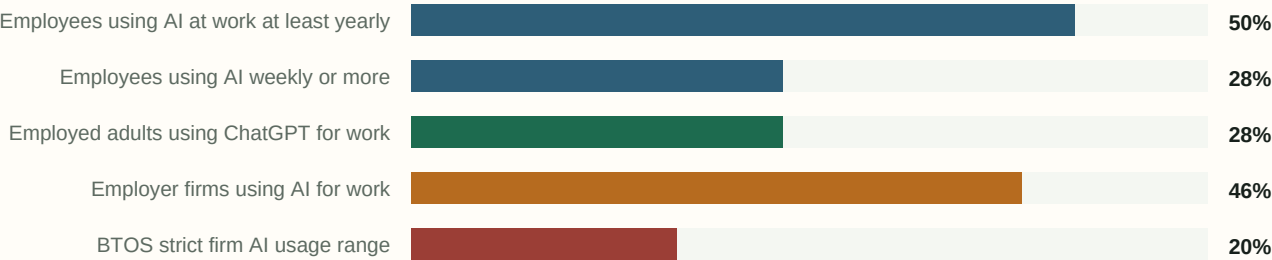


The demoted audience is career-transition professionals. It has high emotion but weak recurrence: the Federal Reserve reports 13% of adults started a new job in 2025, and the New York Fed's March 2026 survey put expected employer-change likelihood at 9.7%. Use it as a lead magnet, not as a core audience. [S10][S11]

Evidence That Matters

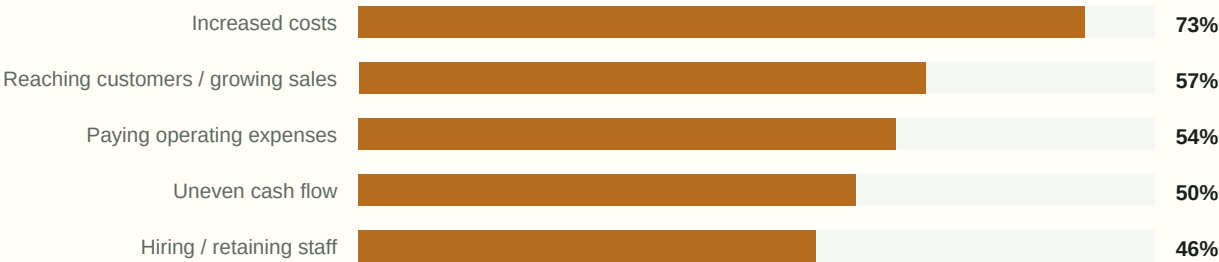
The core assumption is that people will not pay for another AI assistant. They may pay for a structured way to stop carrying a decision alone.

AI readiness: there is enough existing behavior to sell structure, not education



Sources: Gallup Q1 2026 [S6], Pew Jun. 2025 [S5], Fed SBSCS 2026 [S8], Census BTOS May 2026 [S9].

Small-business pain is concrete and decision-shaped



Source: Federal Reserve Banks, 2026 Report on Employer Firms [S8].

Signal	What the data says	Implication for toward.to
Service sellers have budget logic	Upwork reports 28% of U.S. knowledge workers freelance or work independently; exclusive freelancers reported median income of \$85K. [S2]	One improved client recommendation can justify a low-friction subscription.
White-collar pool is huge	BLS reports 71.3M people in management, professional, and related occupations; management/professional weekly median earnings were \$1,645 in 2025. [S3][S4]	This is not a tiny niche, but the message must target recommendation owners, not all office workers.
Small firms have pain and AI curiosity	SBA counts 36.2M small businesses; Fed SBSCS says 46% of employer firms used AI for work at survey time and 15% planned to use it within 12 months. [S7][S8]	The best target is the digitally active owner-operator, not the entire SMB universe.

Audience 1: Consultants / Service Sellers

Definition: Solo consultants, agency owners, fractional operators, recruiters, coaches, accountants, and advisors whose product is judgment.

Age: 30-54. **Gender:** All genders. Do not split by gender at launch; the buying trigger is client-facing pressure.

Emotional anchor: I cannot hand a client a fuzzy recommendation.

Upwork reports 28% of U.S. knowledge workers freelance or work independently, translating to 20M+ people and \$1.5T in 2024 earnings. [S2]

- Best offer: **Client Decision Brief** - turn notes, constraints, and messy client context into a recommendation you can defend.
- Best problem pages: scope creep, pricing recommendation, client priority call, agency strategy recommendation, hiring a contractor.
- Primary ad danger: sounding like generic AI writing. They do not want more words; they want a sharper point of view.

Ad slogans to test

Hook	Emotional job	CTA
Before you send the recommendation, ask what you're missing.	Protect credibility before the client sees the answer.	Build my client decision brief
Your client bought judgment. Bring the sharper version.	Reframe toward.to as professional leverage, not AI novelty.	Pressure-test this client call
Turn a messy client call into a decision your client can say yes to.	Move from discussion to commitment.	Get the next best action

Audience 2: White-Collar Decision Owners

Definition: PMS, ops leads, marketers, analysts, recruiters, chiefs of staff, and managers who must bring recommendations upward.

Age: 27-45. **Gender:** All genders. Use role and problem targeting; gender is not a strategic variable here.

Emotional anchor: I need to walk into the meeting with an answer I can defend.

BLS counts 71.3M people in management, professional, and related occupations. Gallup says 50% of U.S. employees now use AI at work at least a few times a year. [S3][S6]

- Best offer: **Meeting Decision Check** - pressure-test the recommendation before the room pressures you.
- Best problem pages: launch/no launch, cut scope or delay, segment choice, budget tradeoff, hiring recommendation.
- Primary ad danger: never imply the viewer is insecure, failing, replaceable, or about to lose a job. Make the work moment visible, not the person's vulnerability. [S12]

Ad slogans to test

Hook	Emotional job	CTA
Bring the answer that survives the second question.	Status protection in a visible work moment.	Pressure-test my recommendation
Before the meeting, find the blind spot.	Reduce the fear of being exposed by a better question.	Check this decision
Less second-guessing. Better next move.	Turn ambiguity into an action the team can evaluate.	Get my next best action

Audience 3: Small-Business Decision Owners

Definition: Digitally active owners and operators in 2-50 person firms who make pricing, hiring, client, software, and growth calls.

Age: 30-60. **Gender:** All genders. Target by business ownership, software behavior, and decision problem.

Emotional anchor: If this call is wrong, I am the one who pays for it.

SBA counts 36.2M U.S. small businesses. Fed SBCS finds 57% report reaching customers/growing sales as an operational challenge and 73% report increased costs as a financial challenge. [S7][S8]

- Best offer: **Owner's Decision Brief** - make the call before it burns time, cash, or trust.
- Best problem pages: raise prices, hire or wait, fire a client, buy software, invest in a channel, launch a new offer.
- Primary ad danger: targeting every small-business owner. The wedge is digitally active operators, especially services and knowledge-heavy firms.

Ad slogans to test

Hook	Emotional job	CTA
Small business decisions do not feel small when you are the one paying.	Name the owner burden without pity.	Build my owner's decision brief
Before you hire, raise prices, or say yes, get the next best action.	Compress the common decision set into one promise.	Check this business call
Turn owner's doubt into a decision plan.	Make doubt usable instead of paralyzing.	Get the next move

The Pitch

toward.to is not an AI productivity app. It is the place you go before a consequential yes, no, or not yet.

The ad should make the user feel the moment before commitment: the email before the client sees the recommendation, the meeting before an executive asks the second question, the hire before payroll becomes heavier. The promise is not confidence as a vibe. The promise is a more defensible next action.

Campaign	Audience	Landing-page promise	Primary CTA	First test metric
Client Call Rescue	Consultants / service sellers	Turn messy client context into a recommendation you can defend.	Build my client decision brief	Completed decision brief / landing-page visit
Before The Meeting	White-collar decision owners	Find the blind spot before the room does.	Pressure-test my recommendation	Quick-advice starts / landing-page visit
Owner's Next Move	Small-business decision owners	Make the call before it burns cash, time, or trust.	Check this business call	Email capture or trial start / landing-page visit

30-Day Test Plan

- Run three ad sets with equal starting budget: one audience, one pain, one landing promise per ad set.
- Use two emotional hooks per audience and one product proof creative: a sample decision brief, a blind-spot checklist, or a before/after decision frame.
- Do not optimize on click-through alone. Track: landing-page view, quick-advice start, decision brief completion, email capture, and paid intent.
- Kill broad fear language early. The copy should never sound like it knows the viewer is failing, replaceable, broke, or desperate.
- Retain the career-decision angle as a content offer: 'Accept the offer?' can drive leads, but it should not replace the three core audiences.

Copy Guardrails

Weak / risky	Use instead
Worried you'll lose your job?	Before the meeting, pressure-test your recommendation.
Are you a struggling small-business owner?	Before you hire, raise prices, or say yes, get the next best action.
Need AI to think for you?	Bring the context. Toward finds the blind spots and next move.
Founders, be brave.	Before you commit, ask what the decision depends on.

References

All cited numbers in this memo are tied to the references below. Private platform benchmarks should still be validated with your own funnel data.

ID	Source	URL
S1	toward.to public product surface, inspected May 30, 2026	https://toward.to
S2	Upwork Future Workforce Index press release, Apr. 23, 2025	https://www.upwork.com/press/releases/upwork-study-finds-1-in-4-u-s-skilled-knowledge-workers-now-work-independently-generating-1-5-trillion-in-earnings
S3	BLS CPS Annual Averages, Table 11b, 2025	https://www.bls.gov/cps/cpsaat11b.htm
S4	BLS median weekly earnings by occupation, 2025	https://www.bls.gov/news.release/wkyeng.t08.htm
S5	Pew Research Center, ChatGPT use among U.S. adults, Jun. 25, 2025	https://www.pewresearch.org/short-reads/2025/06/25/34-of-us-adults-have-used-chatgpt-about-double-the-share-in-2023/
S6	Gallup artificial intelligence workplace indicator, Q1 2026	https://www.gallup.com/699797/indicator-artificial-intelligence.aspx
S7	SBA Office of Advocacy small-business FAQ, Feb. 3, 2026	https://advocacy.sba.gov/2026/02/03/advocacy-releases-frequently-asked-questions-about-small-businesses-2026/
S8	Federal Reserve Banks, 2026 Report on Employer Firms	https://www.fedsmallbusiness.org/2026-report-on-employer-firms
S9	U.S. Census Bureau, AI Use at U.S. Businesses, May 26, 2026	https://www.census.gov/library/stories/2026/05/ai-use-businesses.html
S10	Federal Reserve, Economic Well-Being of U.S. Households in 2025, May 2026	https://www.federalreserve.gov/publications/2026-economic-well-being-of-us-households-in-2025-employment-and-job-quality.htm
S11	Federal Reserve Bank of New York, SCE Labor Market Survey, Mar. 2026	https://www.newyorkfed.org/microeconomics/sce/labor
S12	Meta Advertising Standards and ad-targeting guidance	https://transparency.meta.com/policies/ad-standards/